ALAGAPPA UNIVERSITY

(Accredited with A+ Grade by NAAC (CGPA : 3.64) in the Third Cycle)

KARAIKUDI

Date: 18.09.2017

"Symposium on Students and Screen: A New Addiction"

A One-Day Symposium on "Students and Screen: A New Addiction" was organized on 18.09.2017, under the aegis of the Department of Women's Studies, Alagappa University, Karaikudi.

Prof.K.Manimekalai, Former Vice-Chancellor of Mother Theresa University, Kodaikanal and currently the Dean, Faculty of Arts, Alagappa University, while welcoming the gathering, highlighted the great relevance and current significance of theme of the symposium and how it is intrinsically linked to students' day-to-day activities. Healthy and productive human resources contributing to the nation's development is the need of the hour and **not addicts of any kind**. Too much dependency on communication gadgets and instruments such as the Television, Cinema, Internet, and Smart Phone have fostered an addictive behaviour on the part of the youngsters. "We should keep these instruments under our control and we should not live under their control", she quipped. Spending quality time with our family members and friends and playing indoor and outdoor games would not only bring happiness but also release us from the clutches of Screen Addiction.

Dr.K.R.Murugan, Professor and Head, Department of Social Work, Alagappa University, while inaugurating the symposium, stated that India's future lies in the hands of the youth population which is almost 40 percentage in the total population of the country. Nurturing vibrant and healthy youth for the nation's development becomes imperative in this context. He added that positive aspects of communication gadgets should be taken into account by the youth for their progress and they should always remember that any addiction would lead to negative impact on their lives making them depressed, irritable and anxiety ridden persons. He illustrated the negative impact caused to some individuals owing to the impact of some negative video games.

While presenting an overview of Screen Addiction, Mrs. Leema Thomas, Psychologist and Student-Counsellor, Alagappa University, said unfortunately that the Screen Addiction could affect people of all age-groups and enumerated the serious symptoms associated with it. Disruption in performing one's normal work and also great difficulty in carrying out ordinary duties and family responsibilities are the two major signs indicating this addiction, she added. The affected person shows a feeling of overwhelming helplessness and anxiety when an attempt is made to stop the screen usage. And the person develops "poor impulse control". By providing Behavioral Therapy, Motivational Support, Family Therapy and Counselling, this addiction could be set right successfully. She said the first phase of treatment should begin with "slow withdrawal" and "digital fasting" and then the addict must be encouraged to take to some hobbies such as reading, gardening, cycling, etc., and to spend more time with family and friends.

In the second session, Prof.J.Frank Ruben Jebaraj of the American College, Madurai, dwelt on the situational factors in Screen Addiction and explained with examples how the human behavior and changes could affect day-to-day way of life. In the third session, Prof.J.John Jeyakamaraj, Department of Computer Science, the American College, Madurai spoke on the impact of Screen Addiction on academic performance of students. He said this addiction affected the students by leading to lack of concentration and poor skill development. He added that it created health problems, poor time-management, etc.

Dr.S.Poul Punitha, Assistant Professor, Centre for Women's Studies delivered a vote of thanks. More than 260 participants attended the symposium.

Prof. V. Balachandran
Registrar i/c.